

Application Q&A: Bobbyard, Product Manager

Pre-filled answers for the Bobbyard application form and likely screen-1 questions. Same human-tone rules as the resume.

Why Bobbyard?

Construction estimators doing three-day takeoffs by hand is the same structural pattern as utility supervisors digging through Oracle CCS for every customer query. A manual expert workflow that AI should compress from days to minutes. I have spent the last six months at ESC Partners shipping that compression for utilities. Bobbyard is the bet on doing it for construction, the largest industry in the world by spend, and one of the least touched by software.

The product matters because the lift is real. **70% automation on quantity takeoff, 3 days to 30 minutes**, Bobbyard 2.0 expanding across drywall, electrical, HVAC, plumbing, framing, and landscaping. That is a category, not a feature.

The team matters because of Michael Ding's background (Stanford engineer plus award-winning mathematician shipping product the lean way) and the 8VC / Pear / Primary / Tishman Speyer / RXR investor stack. This is a vertical-AI bet with serious capital and an unfair model lead. The founding PM seat is the one I would take to put my last six years on the line.

Why this role?

Four lines from the JD describe exactly how I already work:

1. **"Product leader who operates like a founder."** Two prior exits totaling \$575K. I have run product, sales, delivery, hiring, and ops simultaneously across UK and MENA. Founder is the only mode I have ever operated in.
2. **"Live in customer workflows. Get in the field with estimators, PMs, and GCs."** At ESC I sat with utility supervisors, watched them dig through Oracle CCS, mapped their pain into a one-page narrative, and turned it into Maya AI. Field work is where my product instincts come from.
3. **"No handoffs. You are in the details. Specs, Figma, code reviews, user calls."** I am the sole AI on staff at ESC. I write the FastAPI handlers, design the Bedrock prompts, ship the React supervisor cockpit, and run the user calls myself.
4. **"Organized operator. Turn noise into signal and signal into product."** At ESC I get 100+ requests every week from supervisors, customers, and engineering across NEP, Moreno Valley, and Delta Utilities. I turn them into a prioritized backlog every Friday. The 8-factor scoring algorithm I built at SALL is the same muscle applied to recommendations: noise to signal to ship.

The founding-PM seat at Bobbyard is where this profile is most useful. I want a seat where the roadmap is mine and the builder bar is high.

Tell me about a time you went 0 to 1.

Maya AI is the cleanest example. ESC had no AI track when I joined. The CRO wanted Oracle CCS to be smarter, faster, and multi-channel. There was no design doc, no eval framework, no team.

I started with two weeks of customer discovery at NEP. Sat with supervisors. Watched them dig through Oracle CCS to answer a single resident question. Mapped the workflow. Found the failure points: language barriers, response time, manual data entry, no escalation path.

I wrote a one-page product narrative. Picked the stack: AWS Bedrock for model routing, n8n for workflow orchestration, FastAPI for the integration layer, React for the supervisor cockpit, Microsoft Teams adaptive cards for human approval, 11 Labs for 26-language voice.

I built it on Claude Code, end-to-end, in **2.5 months**. Single AI hire. Maya AI is live at NEP with **200K+ residents**, rolling out at Moreno Valley Electrical, piloting at Delta Utilities. It handles **70 to 80%** of first-touch support autonomously and removes **100+** manager emails per day. Projected savings at NEP are around **\$225K per month**.

Founder mode is how I worked then. It is how I work now.

What is your biggest accomplishment?

Two answers depending on the lens.

Career-wise: Bootstrapping and selling CloudApproach plus Approachables for **\$575K combined**. Two ventures across UK and MENA, **200+ agency clients**, **80+ real-estate partners**, **\$5M+** in deals influenced. Two exits before I turned 25.

Last six months: Maya AI live at NEP with **200K+ residents** in **2.5 months** as the sole AI on staff. The team had never shipped AI before. They have shipped it now.

Why are you leaving your current role?

I am not leaving for cause. I am leaving for scope and stage. ESC has been a great place to ship Maya AI, but the next step is a builder-first vertical-AI platform where I help define the product at the seat closest to the founder. Bobbyard is that seat.

Compensation expectations?

The posted range (\$130K to \$150K) is below my market value as an AI PM with the Maya AI track and the founder background. I am open to a conversation. What I care about most is total package and equity in the founding-PM range, given the stage and the scope. If we are aligned on the work, we can find a structure.

Honest framing: I will move for the right opportunity even when the base is not top-of-market, but I will need the equity story to be real.

When can you start?

Immediately. Two-week handoff at ESC for the Maya AI roadmap and supervisor cockpit. I can start day-one work in parallel.

Are you authorized to work in the United States?

I am on STEM OPT (F-1 visa) through 2027 and am H-1B eligible. Happy to walk through the timeline in our first conversation. The cost on Bobbyard's side is straightforward; I am ready to do my part on documentation and timing.

How did you hear about this role?

Found through LinkedIn. Bobbyard fit my criteria across role, stage, and product, so I applied same day.

Open to relocation?

Yes. Open to San Francisco. Can be on-site within 30 days of offer.

Construction background?

None. JD says that is fine. My commitment for the first 30 days, if I am the founding PM:

1. **Week 1:** Shadow five estimators end-to-end. Build a takeoff alongside them.
2. **Week 2:** Map the takeoff workflow into a one-page narrative the team can argue with.

3. **Week 3:** Ship one customer-facing improvement to a workflow I have shadowed.

4. **Week 4:** Write the 90-day roadmap with one big bet and three small ones.

Dangerous in 30 days is a promise I have kept before (Maya AI, 0 to launch in 2.5 months).

Anything else you want us to know?

Three proof links if you want to see the work:

- SALL live: ai-sales-assistant-frontend.onrender.com
- SALL walkthrough: youtube.com/watch?v=eCkP7_ZI348
- Portfolio: shivamsportfolio.webflow.io

Happy to walk through a code-level Maya AI dive at any point in the loop.